

An outpost must resist pawns

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

An outpost is a useful square that enemy pawns cannot easily challenge, often supported by your own pawn. A knight can become powerful there, but the value depends on nearby targets and whether the opponent can exchange it.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A white knight on d5 may be stable if Black lacks c- and e-pawns able to attack it. If Black can play ...c6 safely, d5 may be a temporary station rather than a permanent outpost.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you check beyond whether a square is pawn-safe?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Can the piece be traded favorably, does it attack meaningful targets, and can it retreat if the structure changes? A secure square with no useful influence may be overrated.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

An outpost combines stability with purpose.